Meta and the Future of Content

By Craig Delaune

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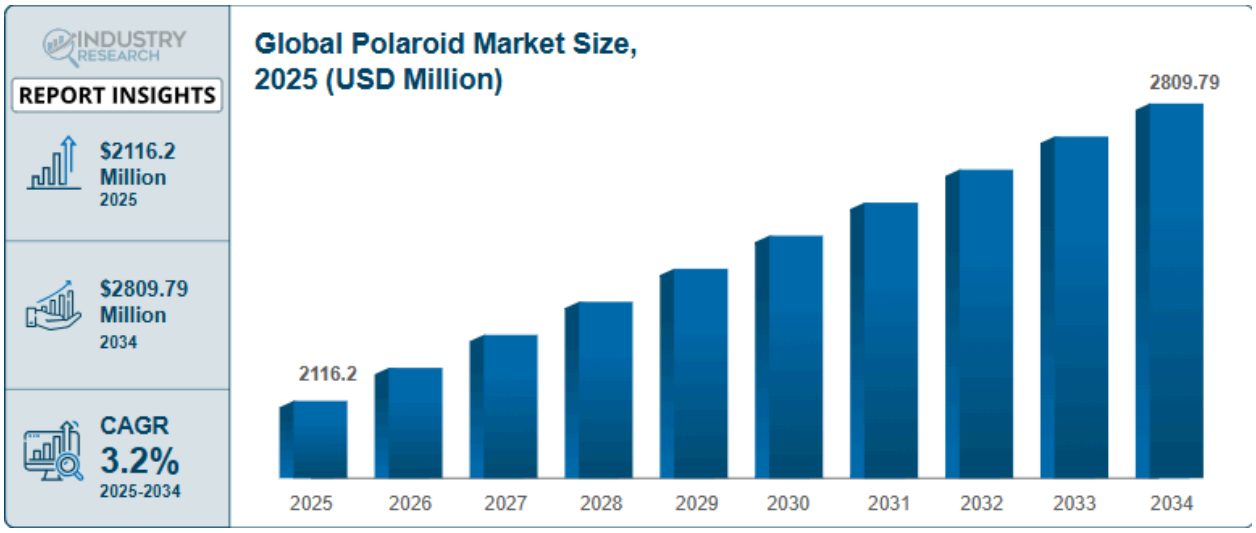
"The Rundown" reposted an interesting essay by Meta Executive and Instagram head, Adam Mosseri, that offers a clear window into Meta's core business in the next phase of The AI Revolution, and hints at what future generations will consume as they scroll on their Meta Glasses. He rebuts the idea that content consumers will only have "AI slop" to enjoy as generative AI content becomes ubiquitous across feeds, and before reading this, I shared that concern. But after reading this post, I realized I was wrong. Kinda. And that Meta is set to dominate in this era too, despite the concerns about AI slop.

I've been telling my friends and family for years now that the next counter culture will be a reversion to the lifestyles portrayed in movies like "Mall Rats," "Fast Times at Ridgemont High," and "American Graffiti." I have always believed that Gen Alpha's children will see TikTok trends as lame, and will trade in their mom's old tripod for a 5 speed.

I see now that content creation isn't going away. It's going to become more real, more raw, and often unflattering. I agree with Adam that we'll see more kids vlogging candid moments that don't feel fake or curated. He notes that this is already happening on Instagram, but I've also noticed it in real life due to the resurgence of polaroid cameras



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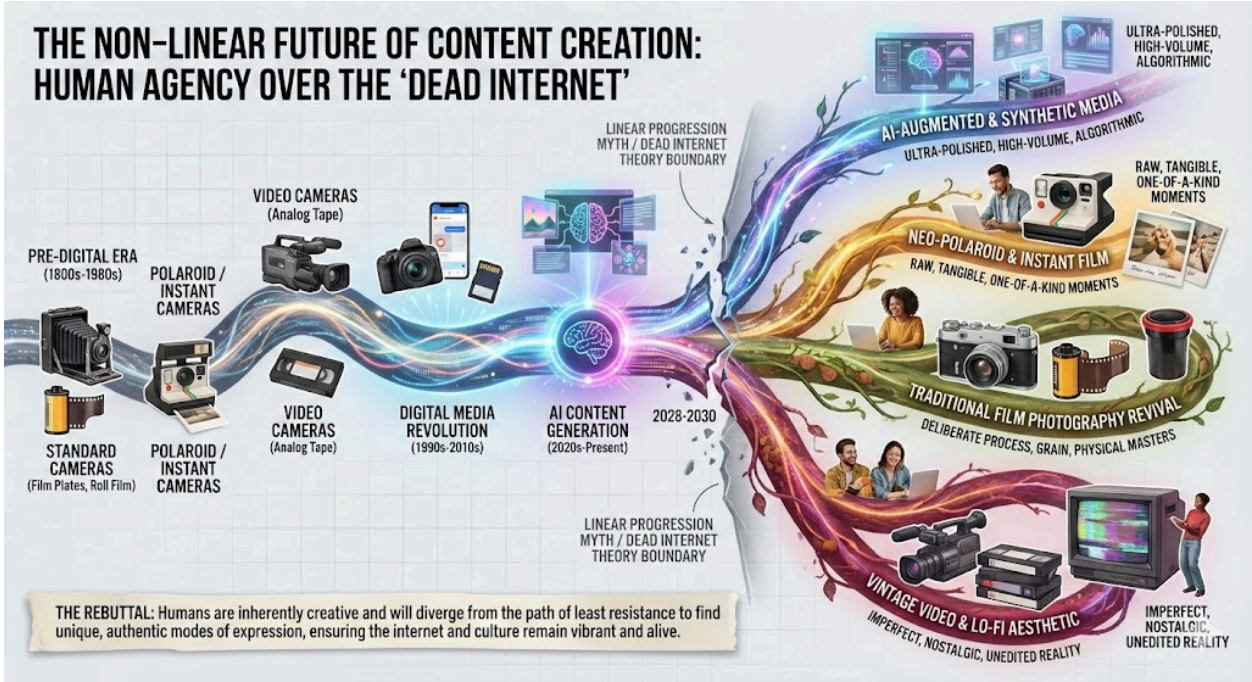
Growth is accelerating in this market, and the consensus is a 3.2% CAGR into 2034. According to Industry Research, 52% of demand growth is driven by rising consumer interest in retro-style instant photography and social media-compatible instant prints. For a product that was left for dead, this is an interesting data point that helps frame where our culture is headed given the adoption of generative AI.

I have two points here. The first is a rebuttal to those who believe that the Dead Internet Theory (the theory that there will be tons of bots and AI content existing in some warped technological ouroboros void of human connection) is coming to fruition. It won't happen. Whether it's with AI tools, raw photography, or wax cylinders, humans are always going to find ways to create engaging content. What is interesting is I've always thought of creation technology as linear - leaning into the polished digital realm where everyone is a professional photographer. What Adam is describing is a refutation to that belief. The “dead” tech of the past will come back to provide audiences with experiences they yearn for, as demand grows for raw, gritty, and hand made content.



Secondly, Meta is the company that will spearhead the shift towards a world that rewards media in all its forms, not just the highly polished video that dominates today. Alongside Google’s YouTube, Meta’s platforms will remain central hubs for content creation, and this interview showed me that Meta is taking the necessary steps to evolve in a new era, where the algorithms are no longer merely ranking production value but rather excavating originality, authenticity, and the human spirit whenever it appears. Meta’s call to arms is arriving precisely when the industry needs it. The next phase of content creation isn’t about teaching creators to appease

algorithms, but about giving them the tools to meet the demand those algorithms are revealing. So to those who say Meta is lost in the sauce of generative AI - you have it backwards. Meta isn't chasing the creator economy, it's preparing the terrain for it. And it always has been.